

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 28

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

Our healing begins with Confession number 7:

"We commit now to live in reality, choosing to believe rather than judge."

Dig around in your toolbox and pull out your Bibles. This is your most powerful tool for life. If you have your Bible with you now, turn to the third chapter of James.

James begins this chapter with a long discourse on how much trouble you can cause with your tongue. It is an inescapable truth that your words reflect the real condition of your soul.

Nancy has paraphrased the text for this lesson using her own translation and KF language. She has translated the Greek word for *wisdom* as *cleverness* because the word *wisdom* can be a little confusing for us as Christians. Cleverness in the context of this passage can be understood as the ability to be creative and skilled in practical matters—with a dash of real self-confidence. This kind of cleverness comes only through experience and training. Let's go ahead and read **James 3:13–18**.

¹³Which one of you has trained to be clever in practical matters and skills? Let that one bring their cleverness to light through excellent behavior and by using their tools gently, as if they were taming a wild animal and turning upside-down the direction of its outcomes.

¹⁴If you have pointed or sharp rivalry within yourself—inner conflicts competing for your time, energy, and effort—and if in your heart you are compelled by selfish ambition to satisfy the needs of your Idol, do not suppress your True Self or others with your egocentric self-promotion; in other words, do not cheat others with deceitful lies that oppose the reality of who you are and how the world really is. When you suppress reality, you take the easy and habitual shortcuts—shortcuts that satisfy your compelling needs and relieve your basic anxiety. You end up suppressing your True Self and the true potential of those around you. ¹⁵The cleverness of habitual shortcuts is not something that comes down from above; it comes from creeping along below, on the earth, having lost connection with heaven, egocentric like a wild animal—inviting, supporting, and motivated by demonic entities. ¹⁶You can look at it this way: Wherever

competing rivalry and selfish ambition exist, there is disorder, anarchy, and cheap, habitual, thoughtless behavior.

¹⁷But the cleverness from above is emphatically first of all holy, and it results in creating peace. It is fitting and appropriate, full of mercy and compassion, and it produces beneficial outcomes. This cleverness does not discriminate as to who benefits from its skills, and these skills are offered without pretense or acting out a role. ¹⁸How is all of this possible? It is possible through the harvest of orientation that has been reaped from seeds planted in peace by those who make peace.

Take a deep breath.

We learn in this passage that orientation is the fruit of the cleverness, or wisdom, from above. Wisdom is the ability to humbly apply knowledge in practical ways that benefit oneself and the community. James tells us that we can only apply this knowledge and produce oriented outcomes in our lives if we learn the practical skills of cultivating peace, first in our own souls and then in the community. We begin by resolving our own misoriented internal conflicts. Our actions then proceed from the soil of an inner calm and produce the fruit of oriented outcomes—outcomes that promote harmonious and peaceful living and help restore the balance of the Creation. We know that this calmness in our soul is healthy for our physical, mental, and spiritual well-being. Our inner calm is also healthy for those around us, and it is certainly healthy for the purposes of God.

Last week, we learned how Paul found this place of peace in the midst of the discomfort of his imagined limitations. God did not remove the limitations that Paul thought were hindering him. Instead, God reminded Paul that limitations are an important part of growing our karis relationship with God. Real strength cannot develop while we are running after imagined possibilities; real strength is the fruit of pursuing a karis relationship with God. Paul willingly and even eagerly accepts the training of his weaknesses, confident in Christ's ability to use his struggle with those areas of weaknesses to produce soul strength. In the midst of various trials, he is willing to submit to the process of becoming all that God created him to be. Paul's karis gift to God is his laborious effort to mature his strength—and that is a great gift, worthy of the karis invitation that God extended to him.

James warns us against falling back into old habits of the cleverness from below and encourages us to access the cleverness from above, which produces orientation and promotes peace. We can then use this cleverness to create peace within ourselves, and into that soil of peace we can plant the seeds that will produce a harvest of oriented outcomes.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Prince of Peace, show me how to cultivate peace. (Repeat)

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time to heal and train together. Hold us in the power of this new direction as You guide us to our real glory. Encourage us in our next training opportunity as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.